

# Shanker Kartik Iyer

Product Designer • Product Lead • Design Systems

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## Summary

Product designer who takes rough ideas to shipped products, working across **design, product ownership, and prototyping in code**. **12+ years** spanning enterprise consulting and early-stage startups. Most recently led design and product at Spotwork through a **ground-up platform rebuild** that **doubled daily shifts within 8 months**. Earlier, joined Deloitte Digital as the **first hire** to set up a design studio and grew it to **30+ designers**.

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## Experience

### Career Break

Nov 2025 – Present

*Planned leave to get married in India (Nov 2025 – Feb 2026)*

- Building AI-assisted prototypes (Feb 2026 – Present) with a focus on adapting **heuristics and error design for agent-computer interaction**.
- Shipped [@calchemy/date-core](#) (Jun 2026), a headless natural-language date parser on npm capable of resolving single dates, date ranges, and **sets of discrete dates** (e.g. mon and fri next month).

### Lead Product Designer & Product Manager, Spotwork

May 2023 – Nov 2025

*On-demand staffing marketplace • Bootstrapped and profitable • total headcount: 25*

- Joined as lead product designer and additionally **took on product management** a year in, leading engineering, data science, and QA through a **ground-up platform rebuild** that **doubled daily shifts within 8 months**.
- Launched onboarding, **bulk shift-posting**, and invoicing across **12 U.S. states in 9 months**.
- Applied behavioral design to **reliability signals and check-ins**, driving **93% first-shift fill** and raising **first-shift attendance by 33%**.
- Delivered **AI-assisted support** that deflected **85% of routine support requests**.
- Resolved identity verification bottlenecks in worker onboarding, cutting **onboarding abandonment by 21%**.
- Led the rollout of a **WCAG-AA** compliant design system in **6 months**, making **release cycles 40% faster**.

## Senior Product Design Consultant, Deloitte Digital

Apr 2019 – Mar 2023

*Consulting for U.S. clients*

- Joined as the **first hire** and **set up the design studio**, establishing design standards and critique practices that maintained deliverable quality as the studio **scaled to 30+ designers**.
- Grew **online order volume by 21%** for Ben E. Keith by **redesigning inventory workflows** to match buyers' mental models.
- Improved truckload order predictability for a Caterpillar subsidiary, **reducing order support queries by 57%**.

## Research Consultant, Gartner

Sep 2017 – Feb 2019

- Drafted **UX priorities playbook for digital transformation initiatives**, supporting **\$650k in new client work**.

## Additional Experience

Senior UI/UX Designer, Grapes Digital • Apr 2016 – Aug 2017

Systems Engineer, Tata Consultancy Services • Jan 2012 – Apr 2015

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## Skills

### Product

Product Strategy • Product Management • Behavioral Design • Mixed-Methods Research • A/B Testing • Stakeholder Workshops

### Design

Design Systems • AI-Assisted Prototyping • Accessibility (WCAG-AA) • Design Ops

### Tools & Tech

Figma • ProtoPie • React • Next.js • TypeScript • CSS • Tailwind • Panda CSS • SQL • Adobe CC • Cursor • Claude Code

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## Education & Certifications

B.E., Computer Science • Rajiv Gandhi Technical University

Interaction Design Specialization Certificate • UC San Diego

Product Management • Indian School of Business